

ZONKE MARKETPLACE

TEAM 1 — REQUIREMENTS & PLANNING

Requirements, Marketplace Flow, Prototype Scope & GitHub Development Tasks

Prepared for the Zonke WIL Software Development Project

Requirements, Marketplace Flow, Prototype Scope & GitHub Development Tasks

Project information	Details
Project	Zonke Marketplace — WIL Software Development Project
Team	Team 1 — Requirements, Marketplace Flow & Planning
System Developers	Tsihifirwa Mohau Mariba; Thando Frank Sithole
Primary reference	Zonke project repository and Team 1 Planning Instructions
Repository	https://github.com/FredrickKcode/zonke
Reference website	https://zonke.me/
Document status	Initial Team 1 requirements and prototype planning

1. Project Understanding

Zonke is being redeveloped from scratch as a marketplace where clients can find service providers, request services, communicate, complete work and handle payments. The project is a WIL Software Development Project and all five teams contribute to one application and one repository.

Team 1 is responsible for defining what Zonke needs to do. The Team 1 output must allow the other teams to understand what needs to be built.

Project direction confirmed by the repository:

Clients can find service providers.

Clients can request services.

Service providers can manage requests.

Users can communicate through the platform.

Work can be completed through the platform.

Payments can be handled appropriately.

Users can create and manage accounts.

Authentication and authorisation are supported.

Cardano is integrated only where it provides a clear purpose.

The system is tested for functionality and security.

The planning instructions also require Team 1 to identify users, define features, write user stories, create user flows, set the prototype scope, prepare requirements for UI/UX/frontend/backend teams, and create GitHub issues.

2. Users and User Requirements

2.1 Primary users

User	Purpose	Main goals
Client	Person looking for a service.	Find a suitable service provider, request a service, communicate, complete the work and make/complete payment.
Service Provider (Freelancer)	Person offering services through Zonke.	Present services, receive and manage requests, communicate with clients, complete work and receive/handle payment.

2.2 Client requirements

ID	Requirement
CL-01	The client must be able to create and manage an account.

ID	Requirement
CL-02	The client must be able to log in and be authenticated.
CL-03	The client must be able to search/browse for a required service.
CL-04	The client must be able to view available service providers.
CL-05	The client must be able to select a service provider.
CL-06	The client must be able to submit a service request.
CL-07	The client must be able to view the status of a service request.
CL-08	The client must be able to communicate with the service provider through the platform.
CL-09	The client must be able to confirm/participate in completion of the work.
CL-10	The client must be able to complete the required payment flow.

2.3 Service provider requirements

ID	Requirement
SP-01	The service provider must be able to create and manage an account.
SP-02	The service provider must be able to log in and be authenticated.
SP-03	The service provider must be able to present/manage the services they offer.
SP-04	The service provider must be able to receive service requests.
SP-05	The service provider must be able to view and manage request status.
SP-06	The service provider must be able to communicate with clients through the platform.
SP-07	The service provider must be able to mark/participate in work completion.
SP-08	The service provider must be able to receive/handle payment through the agreed payment process.

2.4 System requirements

ID	Requirement
SYS-01	The system must support authentication and authorisation.
SYS-02	The system must protect user data and enforce appropriate access permissions.
SYS-03	The system must store and retrieve user, service, request and transaction-related data required by the agreed scope.
SYS-04	The system must support the client-to-service-provider request lifecycle.
SYS-05	The system must provide the APIs/business logic required by the frontend.
SYS-06	Cardano should only be integrated where the team confirms a clear purpose and appropriate technical/business requirement.

3. Required Features

The following feature list converts the requirements into buildable application capabilities.

Feature	Primary user	Purpose	Prototype priority
Account registration	Client / Service Provider	Create an account and select the appropriate user role.	MUST HAVE
Login & authentication	Client / Service Provider	Securely access the platform.	MUST HAVE
Profile management	Client / Service Provider	Create/update information used on the marketplace.	MUST HAVE
Service catalogue / browsing	Client	Discover available services/providers.	MUST HAVE
Service search	Client	Find services/providers based on a need.	MUST HAVE
Service provider profile	Client	Review provider/service information before requesting.	MUST HAVE
Service request	Client	Submit a request to a selected provider.	MUST HAVE
Request management	Service Provider	View and manage incoming requests and their statuses.	MUST HAVE
Request status tracking	Client / Service Provider	See where a request is in its lifecycle.	MUST HAVE
Platform communication	Client / Service Provider	Discuss the requested work.	MUST HAVE
Work completion	Client / Service Provider	Record/confirm completion of the agreed work.	MUST HAVE
Payment flow	Client / Service Provider	Handle payment as required by the marketplace.	MUST HAVE
Authorisation / role access	System	Prevent users from accessing functions that do not belong to their role.	MUST HAVE
Validation & security controls	System	Validate input and protect the application.	MUST HAVE
Cardano integration	Relevant users/system	Use Cardano only if a confirmed use case provides clear value.	DECISION REQUIRED

3.1 Features that can be developed later

Advanced search filters beyond the basic search/browse experience.

Advanced provider discovery/recommendation or ranking.

Advanced reviews/ratings if not confirmed for the first prototype.

Dispute and escalation workflows.

Advanced notifications (for example, multiple notification channels).

Advanced analytics and reporting.

Additional marketplace automation.

Any Cardano functionality beyond the confirmed use case.

These later features are deliberately separated because the supplied project material does not define them as first-prototype requirements. They should be confirmed before being added to the scope.

4. Required Screens

Screen	User	Purpose	Related requirement
Landing/Home	All	Introduce the marketplace and direct users to registration/login or browsing.	General navigation
Registration	Client / Service Provider	Create an account and select/confirm role.	CL-01 / SP-01
Login	Client / Service Provider	Authenticate an existing account.	CL-02 / SP-02
Client Dashboard	Client	Provide access to searches, requests, messages and account functions.	CL-01–CL-10
Service Search/Browse	Client	Search and browse services/providers.	CL-03
Search Results	Client	Display matching service providers/services.	CL-03 / CL-04
Service Provider Profile	Client	Show provider/service information before a request.	CL-04 / CL-05
Request Service	Client	Capture and submit the service request.	CL-06
Request Confirmation/Details	Client	Confirm the submitted request and show its status.	CL-07
Messages/Conversation	Client / Service Provider	Communicate about a request.	CL-08 / SP-06
Client Payment	Client	Complete the agreed payment step.	CL-10
Provider Dashboard	Service Provider	View and manage incoming requests and account functions.	SP-04 / SP-05
Provider Request Details	Service Provider	Review and update a specific request.	SP-04 / SP-05
Provider Service/Profile Management	Service Provider	Manage offered services/profile information.	SP-03
Work Completion	Client / Service Provider	Record or confirm completion.	CL-09 / SP-07

The repository explicitly gives 'Request Service screen and confirmation screen' as an example of how Team 1 requirements are translated into UI/UX work.

5. User Stories

ID	Role	User story
US-01	Client	As a client, I want to create an account so that I can use Zonke as a client.
US-02	Client	As a client, I want to log in so that I can securely access my account.
US-03	Client	As a client, I want to search for services so that I can find a suitable service provider.
US-04	Client	As a client, I want to browse service providers so that I can compare available options before making a request.
US-05	Client	As a client, I want to view a service provider's profile and services so that I can decide whether they are suitable for my needs.

ID	Role	User story
US-06	Client	As a client, I want to request a service from a selected provider so that I can start the service process.
US-07	Client	As a client, I want to see my request status so that I know what stage my request is at.
US-08	Client	As a client, I want to communicate with the provider so that I can discuss the requested work.
US-09	Client	As a client, I want to confirm/participate in completion of the work so that the request can move to completion.
US-10	Client	As a client, I want to complete the required payment so that I can pay for the service.
US-11	Service Provider	As a service provider, I want to create an account so that I can offer services on Zonke.
US-12	Service Provider	As a service provider, I want to manage my profile and services so that clients can understand what I offer.
US-13	Service Provider	As a service provider, I want to receive service requests so that I can manage work requested by clients.
US-14	Service Provider	As a service provider, I want to manage request status so that the client can see the progress of the work.
US-15	Service Provider	As a service provider, I want to communicate with a client so that I can discuss the requested work.
US-16	Service Provider	As a service provider, I want to record/confirm completion of work so that the request can be completed.
US-17	Service Provider	As a service provider, I want to receive/handle payment through the agreed process so that I can be paid for completed work.
US-18	System	As the system, I want to enforce user roles and permissions so that clients and service providers only access authorised functions.

6. Acceptance Criteria

Related item	Area	Acceptance criteria
US-01	Registration	User can choose the correct role; required fields are validated; successful registration creates an account; invalid/incomplete data is rejected.
US-02	Login	Valid credentials allow access; invalid credentials are rejected; unauthenticated users cannot access protected functions.
US-03	Search	Client can enter a service search; matching services/providers are returned; no-match state is shown when there are no results.

Related item	Area	Acceptance criteria
US-04	Browse providers	Client can view available providers; each result provides enough information to open the provider profile.
US-05	Provider profile	Profile displays provider/service information; client can proceed to request the service.
US-06	Request service	Client selects a provider/service; required request information is validated; request is saved; confirmation is displayed.
US-07	Request status	Client can view submitted requests and their current status; status changes are reflected when updated.
US-08	Communication	Authorised client and provider can access the relevant conversation; messages are associated with the appropriate request/users.
US-09	Completion	Completion action is available to authorised users; the system records the completion state; the request cannot remain incorrectly marked as incomplete.
US-10	Payment	Client can reach the payment step for the applicable request; successful/failed payment states are handled; transaction/request status is updated appropriately.
US-12	Provider services	Provider can create/update the information describing services offered; saved information is visible where appropriate to clients.
US-13	Request management	Provider can see incoming requests; provider can take the actions supported by the agreed request lifecycle.
US-14	Status management	Provider can update a request only through allowed statuses/actions; client can see the resulting status.
US-18	Authorisation	Client-only functions cannot be used by service providers and vice versa; protected backend operations validate the user's role.

7. User Flows

7.1 Client journey

Primary flow required by the repository:

CLIENT FLOW Start → Register/Login → Search/Browse Service → View Service Provider → Select Provider → Request Service → Request Confirmation → Communicate → Work Completed → Payment → End

Decision points:

Does the client already have an account? No → Register; Yes → Login.

Are there matching services/providers? No → show no-results state and allow a new search; Yes → view results.

Does the client want to use the selected provider? No → return to results; Yes → request service.

Was the request submitted successfully? No → show validation/error and allow correction; Yes → confirmation.

Is the work complete? No → continue communication/request lifecycle; Yes → completion and payment steps.

Did payment succeed? Yes → mark the applicable transaction/request state accordingly; No → show failure and allow the agreed retry/alternative process.

7.2 Service provider journey

SERVICE PROVIDER FLOWStart → Register/Login → Create/Manage Profile & Services → Provider Dashboard → Receive Request → View Request → Manage/Update Request → Communicate → Complete Work → Payment Handling → End

Decision points:

Does the provider have an account? No → Register; Yes → Login.

Is the provider profile/service information ready? No → complete/update it; Yes → continue.

Is there a new service request? No → remain on dashboard; Yes → open request.

Can/should the provider proceed with the request according to the agreed business rules? If not, use the confirmed rejection/cancellation process; if yes, continue.

Is the work complete? No → continue communication/work; Yes → record completion and continue to payment handling.

The exact reject/cancel/decline rules are an open business decision because they are not specified in the supplied project README.

8. Prototype Scope

8.1 Must-have for first working prototype

Client and service-provider registration.

Login, authentication and role-based authorisation.

Basic client and service-provider profiles.

Service/provider browsing and basic search.

Service-provider profile/service details.

Client service request creation.

Service-provider request viewing and management.

Request status tracking.

Basic platform communication tied to the service/request.

Basic work completion flow.

Payment flow at the level agreed by the project team.

Input validation and basic security controls.

Database support for the core marketplace entities.

APIs connecting the frontend to the backend.

Initial testable end-to-end client and provider journeys.

8.2 Outside first prototype / later

Advanced search/filtering.

Recommendation/ranking systems.

Advanced reviews and ratings unless confirmed by the project manager/CTO.

Complex dispute resolution.

Advanced analytics/reporting.

Multiple advanced notification channels.

Advanced marketplace automation.

Any Cardano feature whose use case has not yet been confirmed.

Any additional business-model feature not confirmed by project direction.

Scope note: the supplied materials explicitly define the marketplace goal and core journeys, but do not provide a complete product backlog or a detailed list of all future features. Therefore, the 'later' list contains planning recommendations and must not be treated as an approved business decision until confirmed.

9. Functional Requirements for Development Teams

ID	Function	Team dependency	Requirement
FR-01	Account registration	Frontend + Backend	The system shall allow a user to register as a client or service provider and validate required information.
FR-02	Authentication	Frontend + Backend	The system shall authenticate registered users and protect authenticated functions.
FR-03	Authorisation	Backend + Frontend	The system shall enforce role-based access for client and service-provider functions.
FR-04	Profile management	Frontend + Backend	The system shall allow users to create/update profile information required for marketplace use.
FR-05	Service management	Frontend + Backend	The system shall allow service providers to manage the services they offer.
FR-06	Search/browse	Frontend + Backend	The system shall allow clients to search/browse available services/providers.
FR-07	Provider details	Frontend + Backend	The system shall allow clients to view relevant service-provider/service details.
FR-08	Service request	Frontend + Backend	The system shall allow an authenticated client to create a service request for a selected provider/service.
FR-09	Request management	Frontend + Backend	The system shall allow a service provider to view and manage incoming requests.
FR-10	Request status	Frontend + Backend	The system shall store and display the current state of a service request.
FR-11	Communication	Frontend + Backend	The system shall provide authorised client/provider communication associated with the service process.
FR-12	Completion	Frontend + Backend	The system shall support recording/confirming completion of work.

ID	Function	Team dependency	Requirement
FR-13	Payment	Frontend + Backend	The system shall support the agreed payment process and record applicable payment/request states.
FR-14	Validation/security	Backend	The system shall validate inputs and protect sensitive operations/data.
FR-15	Cardano	Backend	The system shall only implement Cardano functionality after a clear purpose/use case is confirmed.

10. Core Data Needed

Entity	Purpose	Key information (initial planning)
User	Store identity/authentication-related account data.	User ID, role, name/contact fields, authentication data handled securely.
Service Provider Profile	Represent the provider in the marketplace.	Provider/user ID, profile information, service information.
Service	Represent an offered service.	Service ID, provider ID, service name/description and agreed marketplace fields.
Service Request	Track a client's request to a provider.	Request ID, client ID, provider ID, service ID, request details, status, timestamps.
Conversation/Message	Support platform communication.	Conversation/request reference, sender, recipient, message content, timestamp.
Payment/Transaction	Track the agreed payment process.	Payment/transaction ID, request reference, amount/details as approved, status, timestamps.

These are planning-level data entities derived from the required marketplace journey. Exact database fields, payment model and Cardano data structures must be confirmed by Team 4/project direction.

11. Open Questions and Decisions Required

Question/Decision	Why it matters	Owner to confirm
What exact service categories will launch?	Defines search, service creation and seed/test data.	Project Manager / Product direction
What information must a service provider submit?	Defines registration/profile forms and database fields.	Project Manager + Team 1/2/4
How are prices set: fixed price, quote, or both?	Changes request and payment flow.	Project Manager / Business direction
Can a provider reject/cancel a request?	Defines request statuses and edge cases.	Project Manager
Can a client cancel a request?	Defines lifecycle and payment/refund handling.	Project Manager
What is the exact payment method for the first prototype?	Required for frontend/backend/payment requirements.	Project Manager + Team 4
What is the clear Cardano use case?	Repository requires Cardano only where it has a clear purpose.	Project Manager + Team 4
Are ratings/reviews required in Prototype 1?	Affects screens, database and scope.	Project Manager

Question/Decision	Why it matters	Owner to confirm
What notifications are required?	Affects communication and frontend/backend scope.	Project Manager
What happens when a payment fails?	Defines recovery and request status behaviour.	Project Manager + Team 4
What is the exact work-completion confirmation rule?	Determines who can mark a request complete.	Project Manager
What user verification is required for service providers?	Affects onboarding, security and data requirements.	Project Manager

12. Requirements Traceability

Requirement	Feature	User story	GitHub issue
CL-01 / SP-01	Registration	US-01 / US-11	Create client/provider registration
CL-02 / SP-02	Authentication	US-02 / US-18	Implement authentication and protected routes
CL-03 / CL-04	Search/browse	US-03 / US-04	Implement service/provider search and results
CL-05	Provider profile	US-05	Implement service-provider profile screen/API
CL-06	Service request	US-06	Implement service request flow
SP-04 / SP-05	Request management	US-13 / US-14	Implement provider request management
CL-07	Request status	US-07	Implement request status tracking
CL-08 / SP-06	Communication	US-08 / US-15	Implement request communication
CL-09 / SP-07	Work completion	US-09 / US-16	Implement work completion flow
CL-10 / SP-08	Payment	US-10 / US-17	Implement agreed payment flow
SYS-01 / SYS-02	Authorisation/security	US-18	Implement role permissions and security validation
SYS-06	Cardano	Future/decision-dependent	Define and implement approved Cardano use case

13. Proposed GitHub Issues

Issue	Title	Owner/team	Description & acceptance	Priority
T1-01	Define client and service-provider roles	Team 1 / Backend	Document roles, permissions and user journeys. Acceptance: role definitions and access boundaries are recorded.	High
T1-02	Define prototype requirements and scope	Team 1	Publish approved must-have/later feature list and link requirements to stories.	High

Issue	Title	Owner/team	Description & acceptance	Priority
T1-03	Design client journey flow	Team 1 / UIUX	Create flow from login through search, request, communication, completion and payment.	High
T1-04	Design service-provider journey flow	Team 1 / UIUX	Create flow from login through service management, request management, communication, completion and payment.	High
T1-05	Create client registration/login requirements	Frontend + Backend	Implement and validate client account creation and authentication.	High
T1-06	Create service-provider registration/login requirements	Frontend + Backend	Implement provider account creation and authentication.	High
T1-07	Implement role-based authorisation	Backend	Protect client/provider-specific operations and routes.	High
T1-08	Implement user profile management	Frontend + Backend	Allow authenticated users to create/update required profile data.	High
T1-09	Implement service-provider service management	Frontend + Backend	Allow providers to create/update the services they offer.	High
T1-10	Implement service browsing/search	Frontend + Backend	Allow clients to browse/search available services/providers and view results.	High
T1-11	Implement service-provider profile view	Frontend + Backend	Allow clients to open a provider profile and see relevant service information.	High
T1-12	Implement client service request	Frontend + Backend	Allow client to submit a request and receive confirmation.	High
T1-13	Implement provider request management	Frontend + Backend	Allow provider to view and manage incoming requests according to approved statuses.	High
T1-14	Implement request status tracking	Frontend + Backend	Display request status to the relevant client/provider and persist status changes.	High
T1-15	Implement request communication	Frontend + Backend	Provide authorised communication associated with a service/request.	High
T1-16	Implement work completion flow	Frontend + Backend	Allow the approved party/parties to record completion and update request state.	High

Issue	Title	Owner/team	Description & acceptance	Priority
T1-17	Implement approved payment flow	Backend + Frontend	Implement the confirmed payment method and payment/request status handling.	High
T1-18	Define Cardano use case	Project Manager + Team 4	Confirm a clear purpose for Cardano before implementation; document decision.	Medium
T1-19	Create initial marketplace test cases	Team 5	Test registration, search, request, communication, completion, payment and permissions.	High
T1-20	Create Team 1 requirements documentation	Team 1	Store requirements, user stories, flows, scope, acceptance criteria and decisions in docs/.	High

14. Handover to Other Teams

Team 2 — UI/UX

Use the required screens and user flows in this document as the basis for wireframes/Figma.

Design clear states for registration, login, search results, provider profile, service request, request status, communication, completion and payment.

Include validation/error/empty states identified in the acceptance criteria.

Team 3 — Frontend

Build the screens and interactions against the approved requirements and Team 2 designs.

Connect the UI to backend APIs for authentication, profiles, services, requests, communication, completion and payment.

Keep client/provider role behaviour consistent with the authorisation requirements.

Team 4 — Backend, Database & Cardano

Design database entities and APIs supporting users, services, requests, messages and payments.

Implement authentication, authorisation, validation and business rules.

Confirm the payment method and Cardano use case before implementing those parts.

Do not commit passwords, private keys, seed phrases, API keys or other secrets.

Team 5 — Testing & Security

Test the end-to-end client and provider journeys.

Test invalid inputs, permissions and protected operations.

Test request status transitions, communication, completion and payment states.

Record evidence, bugs and retest results.

15. Evidence and Contribution

Team 1 should keep evidence of its contribution. Recommended evidence includes:

Final requirements document committed to the repository.

User-flow diagrams.

GitHub Issues created/updated by Team 1.

Meaningful commits showing individual contribution.

Screenshots of the repository documentation and issues.

Records of decisions and open questions communicated to the other teams.

The project instructions require each System Developer to be able to show their own contribution and recommend keeping screenshots, diagrams, commits and other useful evidence.

16. Final Team 1 Definition of Scope

For the first working prototype, Zonke should demonstrate a complete basic marketplace journey: a user can register/login in the appropriate role; a client can search/browse and select a service provider; the client can submit a service request; the provider can receive and manage that request; both parties can communicate; the work can be recorded as completed; and the agreed payment flow can be handled. Authentication, authorisation, validation and security controls must support the journey. Cardano is included only after a clear project-approved purpose is confirmed.

This scope is intentionally focused on the project's documented marketplace goal and the Team 1 planning responsibility. Features not specified in the supplied materials remain decisions for the project manager/product direction rather than assumptions made by Team 1.

17. Sources Used

1. Zonke Redevelopment Project — Team 1: Requirements & Planning, supplied PDF.
2. Zonke Marketplace — WIL Software Development Project, GitHub repository:
<https://github.com/FredrickKcode/zonke>
3. Zonke website supplied by the project team: <https://zonke.me/>

Source note: where the project materials did not specify a business rule (for example cancellation, ratings, exact payment method or exact Cardano use), this document identifies the item as an open decision rather than presenting it as an approved project fact.